



Aki Fukai

Principal Product Designer

Enterprise SaaS &
Regulated Platforms

- 🇨🇭 Work Permit: Swiss Citizen (EU/EFTA)
- 📍 Location Hamburg, DE (Hybrid / Remote)
- 📅 B2B Retainer Contracts (3–18+ months)
- ➡️ Available now · 3–5 days/week

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Skills & Competencies

Design Systems & UI Architecture

- Multi-Brand and Multi-Tenant Systems
- Multi-Device Systems (*web, mobile, POS*)
- Semantic Token Taxonomy
- Design System Migration
- Storybook · zeroheight
- WCAG 2.1, WCAG 2.2, EN 301 549

Design Engineering & AI Tooling

- Figma (*variables/tokens, auto layout, MCP*)
- Design-to-Code Pipelines
- VS Code · Claude Code CLI
- CSS Variables · Motion Specs
- Git Workflows (*GitHub / GitLab*)

Collaboration Tools

- Notion · Miro · FigJam · Excalidraw
- JIRA · Asana · Linear · Slack

Methods & Strategy

- Agile/Scrum/Kanban · Shape Up
- Jobs-to-be-Done (*JTBD*)
- Event Storming & Service Design
- Lean UX & Prototyping
- Audit-to-Implementation Cycles

Languages

German: Native · English: C1 · French: B1

Education

HAW Hamburg, Communication Design

Principal Product Designer with 20+ years in digital product and service design, focused for the last 13 years on high-complexity B2B SaaS, regulated platforms, and AI-driven workflows. I turn strict compliance mandates, multi-tenant RBAC architectures, and high-volume data into scalable, audit-proof platforms, from product discovery to production-ready design systems.

Project Experience

Two decades of B2B contract work; two of these contracts became permanent roles.

Principal Product Designer & Design System Architect

Independent Consultant

Jul 2024 – Present · Freelance contract · Remote/On site

- **PropTech Startup** (Stealth): Built the brand identity and a zero-to-one design system; enabled AI-assisted frontend development. 2025 – 2026
- **Healthcare SaaS** (NDA): Led product discovery and built a validated UX roadmap for expansion in a regulated clinical environment. 2025
- **Ringer/ATOSS** (HR Tech SaaS): Led UX architecture, rebranding, and relaunch; moved enterprise HR workflows onto design token standards. 2025
- **1komma5°** (Clean Energy): Design system consulting and cross-device component libraries for internal product squads. 2024

Design Director

whatever.works (JobRad Venture) · HR Tech

May 2023 – Jun 2024 · Freelance contract · Remote

- Launched **market-ready MVP in 70 days** using Shape Up, reaching **30+ enterprise clients** in year one.
- Built multi-tenant UX compliance for **150+ international jurisdictions**, with Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Single Sign-On (SSO), and HRIS API integrations.
- Cut design-to-engineering handoff friction with tokenized component governance. The product won a **"Best HR Startup 2023"** award.
- Built out the design function and established async design ops.

Co-Founder & Founding Designer

Hello Meet – Group Scheduling · Privately Funded Start-Up

Jan 2018 – Mar 2024 · Co-founder · Hamburg and remote

- Led product strategy and **0-to-1 design** across iOS, Android, and Web for a group scheduling app.
- Used the Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) framework and purpose-built mapping tools for hypothesis testing, user discovery, and conversion rate optimization.
- Built **local-first C2B business model** and service flows; validated purchase intent at **15-25% commission** through lean experiments.
- Designed and maintained cross-platform UI and design systems across **iOS, Android, and Web**.

Principal Product Designer

PlasticPlan (Henkel Venture) · RegTech · Circular Economy

Feb – Jul 2022 · Freelance contract · Remote

- Designed AI-driven classification UX for automated plastic tax compliance. Enterprise users cut regulatory reporting costs by **up to 80%**.
- Built audit-proof dashboards for high-throughput workflows across **236M+ data points, 800K+ packaging components**, and **160K+ auto-classified products**.
- Translated AI validation models into low-cognitive-load interfaces that improved human-in-the-loop audit accuracy and verification speed.
- Delivered a bilingual (DE/EN) component library that met EU sustainability and reporting standards.

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Senior Product Designer

enfore AG · Commerce OS · Retail FinTech
Jun 2018 – May 2020 · Freelance-to-permanent · Hamburg (hybrid)

- Designed POS and ERP software platform distributed by major European telecom partners.
- Optimized retail workflows for barcode scanning, inventory tracking, fast role switching, and multi-location database synchronization.
- Created modular KPI dashboards for real-time multi-store monitoring and order fulfilment.
- Scaled complex multi-device UI across desktop, tablet, mobile, and custom POS hardware for non-technical SMB operators.

Founding Senior Interaction Designer

collectAI (Part of Otto Group) · FinTech
Feb 2016 – Feb 2018 · Freelance-to-permanent · Hamburg (on-site)

- Designed the UX/UI for an AI-driven receivables platform that grew to €25M in processed receivables within 18 months.
- Built white-label B2C payment journeys and self-service debt-resolution flows that met GDPR, PSD2 and financial-sector rules.
- Created white-label design token systems to speed up deployment for tier-1 enterprise rollouts.

Lead Interaction Designer

SBB Swiss Federal Railways (IVEG) · Public Sector
Nov 2015 – Sep 2016 · Freelance contract · Bern, Switzerland 🇨🇭 (on-site > hybrid)

- Digitized field maintenance with an offline-first GIS mapping tool for remote infrastructure crews.
- Linked field data capture directly to back-office ERP databases that eliminated paper processing.
- Built and documented a UI component libraries (Web and iPad) that met Swiss Federal accessibility and branding standards.

Senior Interaction Designer

frog for Siemens/Unify · Enterprise Communication
Sep 2013 – Jan 2014 · Freelance contract · Munich (on-site)

- Designed real-time collaboration UX for "Project Ansible" (launched commercially as Unify Circuit) with Siemens product managers and software architects.
- Maintained cross-platform parity across WebRTC video, chat, and document-sharing on Web, iOS, and Android.

Additional Enterprise Experience

- **Mercedes-Benz** (Automotive): Design System Refactoring 2022 – 2023
My Mercedes Customer Platform Architecture 2009
- **Babymarkt** (E-Commerce): UX Audit & Conversion Optimization 2022
- **Tagesspiegel** (Media): Enterprise UX Architecture & Relaunch 2022
- **SAP** (Enterprise IT): Fiori Design System & App Finder UX Architecture 2015
- **Scout24 Schweiz** (Marketplace): Mobile & Web Search Architecture 2015
- **Immonet** (Marketplace): UX Architecture, Prototyping & UX Research for Web Search 2013
- **Telefónica O2** (Telco): UX Architecture & Design Lead for O2.de Relaunch 2011
- **Rossmann** (E-Commerce): Multi-portal Enterprise E-Commerce Relaunch 2008 – 2012
- **CTS Eventim** (E-Commerce): Core UX Architecture for Eventim.de Relaunch 2008

References

Executive references and contact details available upon request. References include leadership from WHATEVER.WORKS, Henkel, enfore AG, Hello Meet, collectAI, SBB CFF FFS, and frog Munich.